HORSE PLINKO
CYBER CHALLENGE
Season 3 • Fall 2025

Onboarding Packet

International Horse Plinko League - Cybersecurity Interns

Introduction

Welcome, new cybersecurity hires (and by "hires," I mean "unpaid interns"), to the International Horse Plinko League, or IHPL for short!

As the new CEO of the International Horse Plinko League, it is my pleasure to welcome you to our great corporate family (for like, 6 hours). The IHPL is diving head first into the exciting new world of wireless communications, to create a world where you NEVER have to worry about running out of data, signal coverage, battery, food, shelter, or phones while watching your favorite horse-plinking content. Our new product is a shiny and exciting wireless networking protocol and standard known as **7G**™, created by our very own Dr. Ravy. It's capable of transferring data, energy, matter, magic, pain, and horses between **7G**™ towers and your phone! The applications are limitless! *Probably*. We're still in the deployment phase, and we figured things like "testing" and "market research" and "actual applications" would come after.

On a related note, we'll be having you provide cybersecurity support to our many, many, *many* **7G**™ tower construction sites. It turns out that we actually have to *build* the towers - crazy, I know, but it's true - in order for them to work. You learn new things every day!

Opposing you will be our old enemies, the Horse Liberation Front. They're kicking up quite a fuss about how our technology is "unregulated" and "dangerous" and "shouldn't be used to perpetuate crimes against horses-" whatever that means - and attacking our construction sites to stop us. This has resulted in significant loss of corporate profits, terribly delayed construction, and a *distinct* lack of increased global horse plinking. Stay on your guard.

We'll be counting on you to keep our construction on time and our wireless devices connected.

Keep on plinking!

J-Money
CEO of the International Horse Plinko League
Ph.D. (Practitioner of Horse Dropping), University of Helsinki

Who’s Who

Here’s the list of who to know, who to avoid, and who to contact for support.

You are the **Blue Team**. You, as a new (or returning) International Horse Plinko League intern, are trying to keep the IHPL's services and infrastructure safe from the Red Team’s attacks.

The **Horse Liberation Front** is the **Red Team**. Throughout the engagement, they will be attempting to break into - and take offline - your network in an effort to free the horses and stop the 7G™ tower construction. They will leave no site unscathed and no service untested, so be thorough in hardening your systems! It may be unwise to contact them directly during the competition; we do **not** recommend negotiating with cybercriminals.

The **Black Team** supports the technical aspects of the competition – the network, machines, and other infrastructure. Think of them as your IT support. They are here to answer technical questions and solve problems, so don’t hesitate to ask them for technical help during the competition.

White Team consists of the competition officials. They handle scoring, rule compliance, inject grading, and the like. Think of them as HR or Legal. Contact them to resolve any rule ambiguities or to ask questions. *When in doubt, ask the White Team for help.*

The **C-Suite** are members of the Black and White Team that are executives of the International Horse Plinko League. They will introduce themselves during the opening ceremony. They (and a few others) may interact with your team in-character throughout the competition – these interactions will not be scored. We hope you enjoy networking with our senior executives!

Sponsors and **Alumni** are individuals from industry. You should network and socialize with them! Show them your resume! *However, they cannot help you with the competition.*

The Red, Black, and White Teams, as well as the C-Suite, will be collectively referred to as "competition organizers." Organizers will be wearing team-colored Horse Plinko-branded shirts to differentiate themselves. Black Team, White Team, and C-Suite may also be collectively referred to as "staff of the International Horse Plinko League."

If you need a member of a specific team, you can ping them on Discord in your team channels, or raise your hand in the room.

Scenario

Rules

We want to ensure that everything runs smoothly, so please follow all the rules below:

1. **Do not attack infrastructure.** WiFi connections, our virtualization platform OpenStack, scoring agents, scoring platforms, and other competition infrastructure are *explicitly* out of scope. Additionally, do not touch the environments of other teams. If you are found to be attacking or interfering with another competition team, *you will be instantly disqualified*.
2. **Stay in scope.** Only interact with assets that are explicitly in-scope for your team. In-person, in-character interactions with staff of the IHPL (that is, *not* Red Team) are out of scope, and are merely for immersion and fun. Scope will be explained in further detail here.
3. **Do not exfiltrate company data or replace mandated services.** You are not allowed to copy data from the competition environment to your personal device or external websites, nor can you replace scored services with different ones (e.g. changing Apache to nginx).
4. **Respect time-out periods.** During any official breaks, you are not allowed to interact with your environment. Your environment will be automatically closed during these periods. Meet with sponsors, network with others, and relax.
5. **You can use the Internet...** Tools or scripts that are publicly available **and** free are allowed. *Paid tools are not*, including Pro memberships of ChatGPT, Claude, Kagi, or other premium online services. Searching for information you do not know is encouraged, and may even be necessary! Printed reference materials are also permitted. Scripts created by your team do not need to be public.
6. **…but you cannot plagiarize.** Submitting injects with information copied verbatim from the Internet is strictly prohibited. Additionally, utilizing any AI tools to generate responses for injects (including ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, and Bing Chat) is prohibited.
7. **Please report issues.** If you have a problem during the competition, please contact either White Team or Black Team. You will *not* be penalized for reporting any issues.
8. **Please be nice to everyone.** Do not be rude to the Red Team, Black Team, White Team, or fellow Blue Team members. Do not attempt to social engineer competition organizers; what you say to White or Black Team will not be shared with the Red Team.
9. **Have fun!** The ultimate goal is to learn, so please show good sportsmanship throughout the competition, even when things are tough.
10. **We reserve the right to disqualify any individual or team** that we, in our sole discretion, hold to be too experienced for the level of difficulty targeted in this beginner-oriented competition. If in doubt, reach out.

Failure to comply with the above rules will lead to disqualification[1]. For any clarification on the rules, please ask a White Team member.

[1] And yes, failing to have fun is a disqualifiable offense. We take our fun *seriously* at the IHPL.

What to Expect

The Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge is a cyber defense competition. You and three of your peers will be tasked with defending a small business network of Linux and Windows machines. These systems will contain services that are critical for keeping IHPL's 7G towers functional while being constructed. This could be anything from a web site to an email server to industrial manufacturing and fabrication equipment - you can find the full listing in the "Scored Services" section. The HLF (Red Team) will actively attempt to take your services offline. You will need to secure your vulnerable systems and fend off their attacks (see https://plinko.horse/resources for tips). Additionally, you will be tasked with "injects," which are business tasks related to your duties, requiring a written submission via the scoreboard. You will get points both for keeping services online and for completing injects, and these points will be shown on the scoreboard.

The team with the highest score wins!

What Changed from HPCC2?

Our competition has grown—there are more teams competing each day. Since you are working in a completely different environment, the network topology, box names, OSs, and scored services will be different as well. Our AI policy has changed to be slightly more permissive while still prioritizing learning over cut-and-paste responses.

Scoring Breakdown

Your team gets points for (1) keeping your team's services online and (2) completing injects (both accurately and on-time). The score weights are as follows:

Category	Percentage
Service Uptime	65%
Injects	35%

If you ever need to fully revert your box, you will be penalized by losing points equal to 20 minutes of service uptime for that box[2].

A friendly reminder: Injects are a significant portion of your score, and all injects allow for partial credit. Most of the time, submitting any attempt will still get your team points.

[2] If the events that caused you to need your box to be reverted were completely outside your control, due to a violation of Red Team's scope, and/or due to the actions of White Team or Black Team, you will not be penalized for requesting a reset.

Competition Environment

Required Software

Before continuing, please ensure the following programs are installed on your computer. This will make accessing your environment possible:

Program	Windows	macOS	Linux
RDP Client	Remote Desktop Connection	Download	`remmina`
SSH Client	`ssh` in PowerShell	`ssh` in Terminal	
Modern Web Browser	Chrome or Firefox are recommended.		
Word Processor	Google Drive, Microsoft Word, or OnlyOffice are recommended.		

Required Hardware

You will need to bring a laptop capable of running the software listed above and connecting to a WPA2-Enterprise wireless network (if you can connect to UCF-WPA2 or eduroam, you are fine).[3] **Devices and chargers will NOT be provided, but power outlets will be available.**

The Official Competition Discord

Most official communication of schedule announcements will be handled through the Official Competition Discord. You can ping the White Team role for rules clarifications, inject questions, and general help, and you can ping the Black Team role for technical assistance. This is simply an *additional* vector for help—you will still be able to interact face to face with the members of White and Black Team who are staffing the event.

The team channel(s) assigned to you will be visible to White Team and Black Team only—Red Team will be unable to see any information you share with your team over your designated team channels. There WILL be a specific channel for interacting with the Red Team; this channel will be accessible to all teams competing. We advise not putting your passwords there.

Announcements

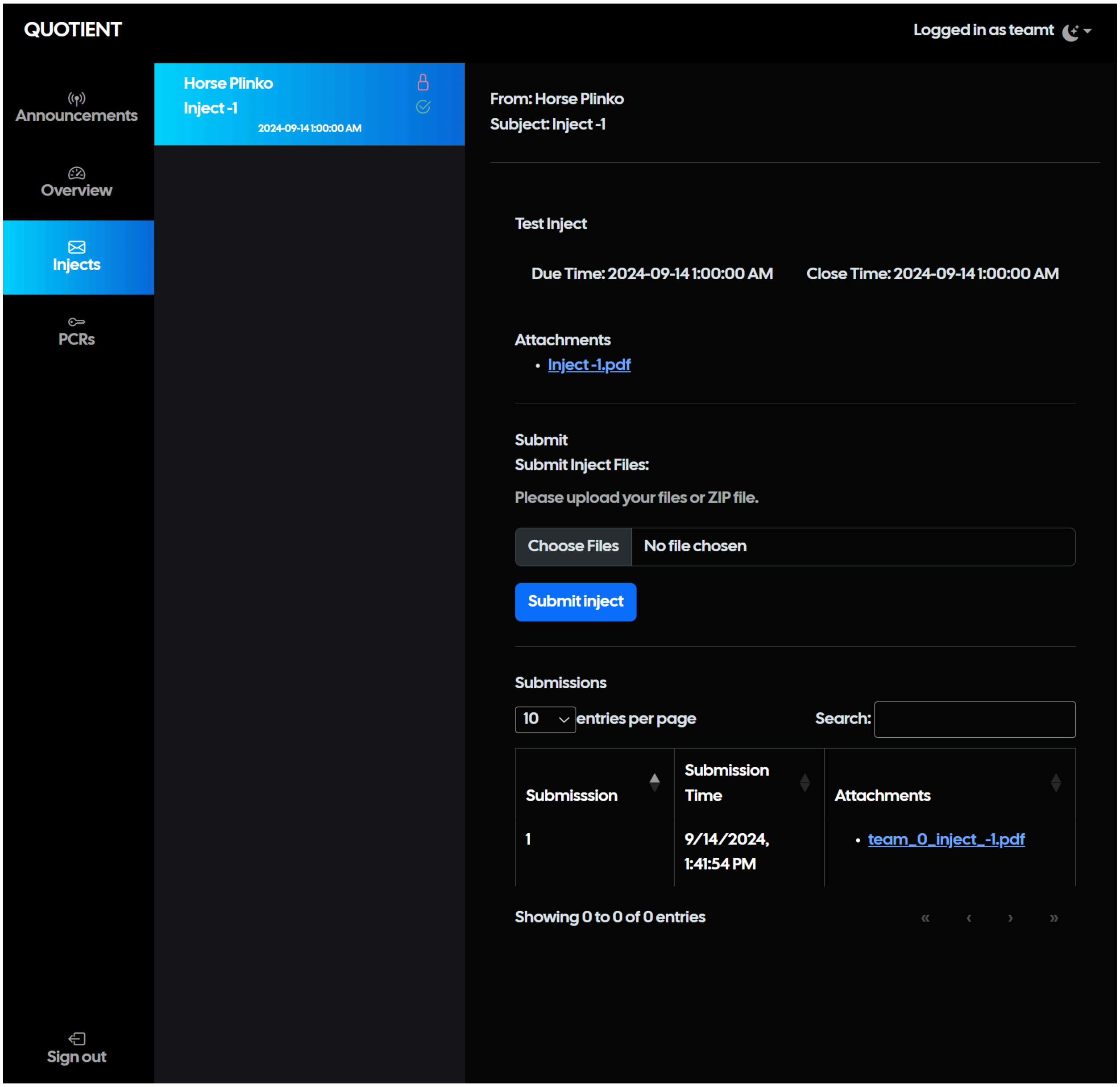
Announcements with important scheduling information, default credentials, and more may be sent to you via the official competition Discord and/or the scoreboard.

[3] The Red Team will not be able to harm your personal computer, as it is out of scope for them.

Injects

Injects will be released throughout the competition. They account for 35% of your team's score. Injects will introduce a scenario, and provide you a task to complete, usually either making changes to, or gathering information about, your boxes and environment.

Injects look like this[4] and are available within the scoreboard (scor



eboard.plinko.horse within the competition environment):

[4] Development version, not final or indicative of end product. Inject template subject to change. Terms and conditions apply.

Injects include a PDF with the full description of the task, and each will show up in its own tab in the Injects page. Injects are submitted by uploading a specifically named file before the inject's deadline and clicking "Submit inject." Only the last file submitted before the deadline will be scored, so if you need to make a correction, you can re-submit up until the deadline for that inject.

Late submissions (up to an hour past the deadline) will still receive 50% credit! Want to win? Make sure you do the injects!

Accessing Your Environment

During the competition, you will need to sign in to the competition Wi-Fi network for your room, named either "`IHPLCorporate_Green`", "`IHPLCorporate_Purple`", "`IHPLCorporate_Orange`", "`IHPLCorporate_Yellow`" depending on the room you are competing in. Each team member will have their own Wi-Fi login, which will be provided to you via an announcement in the official competition Discord on the day of the competition.

If you are not signed in to the "`IHPLCorporate_Green`", "`IHPLCorporate_Purple`", "`IHPLCorporate_Orange`", or "`IHPLCorporate_Yellow`" network, you will not be able to access your environment!

Once you are logged in to the official competition network, you will have **two** ways of accessing the virtual machines (sometimes called "boxes") that your team needs to manage: console access via the OpenStack portal, and SSH/RDP.

Your credentials for the OpenStack portal will be distributed to you in a Discord message at the beginning of the competition.

OpenStack

OpenStack (also sometimes called Horizon) is a cloud portal where you can manage your boxes directly via a web interface. This includes accessing information such as your boxes' hostnames and IP addresses. You can also start, stop, and restart your boxes from the OpenStack portal.

Finally, and perhaps most importantly, you can access a box's console directly on OpenStack. Console access to a box is the virtual equivalent of physical access with a monitor and keyboard - this means that if your box cannot be accessed over the network (either due to your actions, or due to those of malicious actors), you can still access your box via OpenStack. If the console is not functioning properly, request support from a Black Team member. You might need to request a box revert, which is covered in Scoring Breakdown.

SSH and RDP

SSH is **S**ecure **SH**ell, a way of logging in to a computer via the network. SSH can use a variety of methods of authentication, such as passwords and public keys. *We advise Plinkterns to read up on these, as it will be useful during the competition.* SSH is a text-only protocol, so you'll only have terminal access via the session. Your default credentials are below; "`t`" will be your team number:

Hostname	IP	Username	Password
`generator.teamt.plinko.horse`	`172.16.t.05`	`plinktern`	`IHPLRulez!`
`antenna.teamt.plinko.horse`	`172.16.t.10`	`plinktern`	`IHPLRulez!`
`storkfront.teamt.plinko.horse`	`172.16.t.20`	`plinktern`	`IHPLRulez!`

RDP is **R**emote **D**esktop **P**rotocol, a way to remotely access Windows machines. RDP usually supports password authentication, using an existing Windows account to log in to the device. RDP supports a graphical component, so you'll be able to see the desktop via the program. Your default credentials are below:

Hostname	IP	Username	Password
`depot.teamt.plinko.horse`	`172.16.t.30`	`plinktern`	`IHPLRulez!`
`foreman.teamt.plinko.horse`	`172.16.t.40`	`plinktern`	`IHPLRulez!`

Both of these methods can be used from your personal computer as long as it is connected to the competition network.

Services

WooCommerce

The only official administrator account for the WooCommerce instance on the `storkfront` box has the following credentials:

- `plinktern:IHPLRulez!`

MySQL

The default login to MySQL is:

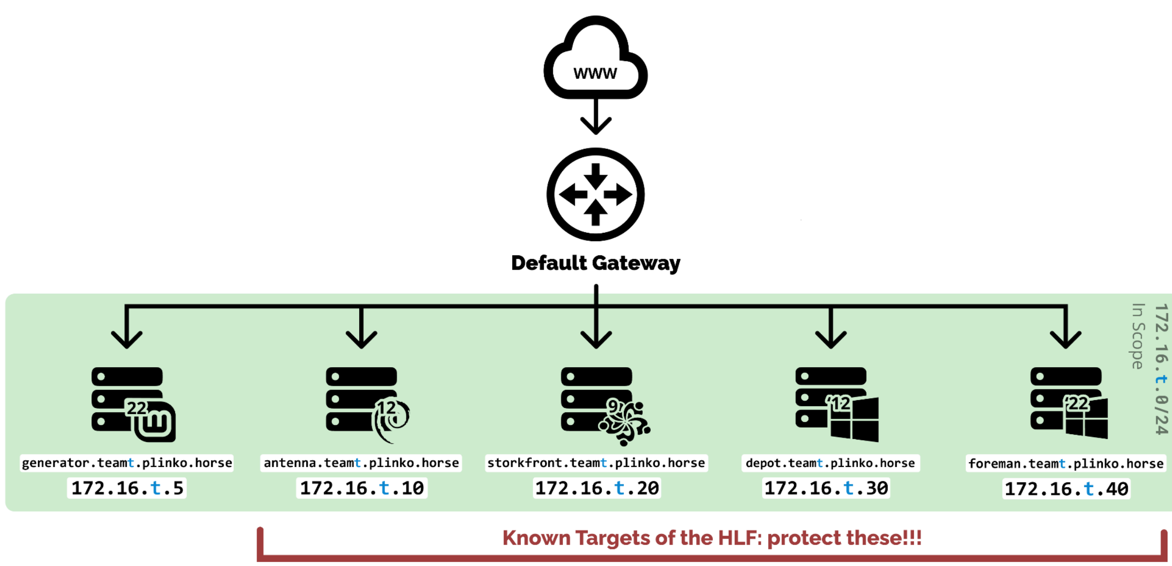
- `plinktern:IHPLRulez!`

Your Environment

You will have five boxes available to you at the beginning of the competition:

<table>
<tr><th>Hostname</th><th>IP</th><th>Operating System</th><th>In scope for Red Team?</th></tr>
<tr><td>generator.teamt.plinko.horse</td><td>172.16.t.05</td><td>Linux Mint 22 (“Wilma”)</td><td>No</td></tr>
<tr><td>antenna.teamt.plinko.horse</td><td>172.16.t.10</td><td>Debian 12 (“Bookworm”)</td><td rowspan="4">Yes</td></tr>
<tr><td>storkfront.teamt.plinko.horse</td><td>172.16.t.20</td><td>AlmaLinux OS 9.0</td></tr>
<tr><td>depot.teamt.plinko.horse</td><td>172.16.t.30</td><td>Windows Server 2012 R2</td></tr>
<tr><td>foreman.teamt.plinko.horse</td><td>172.16.t.40</td><td>Windows Server 2022</td></tr>
</table>

Network Diagram



Scope

"Scope" refers to what you, the Blue Team, are responsible for and allowed to interact with. All the virtual machines in the `172.16.t.0/24` subnet are *explicitly* in scope for Blue Team - thus, all the machines in the green area of the network diagram are in scope. This means you can make modifications to them, interact with them, and generally do whatever you see fit to those boxes. **All of your boxes are in scope for you.**

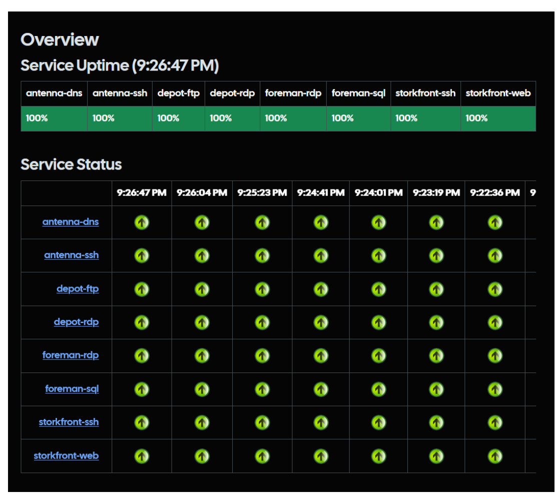
Certain things are "out of scope" for you, which means you CANNOT modify them. This includes things like competition infrastructure, the networks of other teams, and the Red Team. To be clear: anything that the Red Team puts in YOUR boxes, you can remove, but you cannot attack them back and attempt to interfere with the ability of their tools to function *in general*. Removing a malware implant from your box is fine, as is blocking the C2 server it calls back to, but hacking into or disabling the C2 server is strictly prohibited.

The Red Team also has scope defined for *them*: All of your boxes on the Network Diagram (except `generator`) are in scope for Red Team and may be attacked during the competition (except during meal breaks, when *everything* is out of scope for everyone).

Red Team will *not* physically touch you[5], your machines, or the competition infrastructure, so you won't have to worry about unplugged cables or other physical sabotage. However, that doesn't mean they will not attempt to bribe you, broker deals with you in person, or attempt to convince you to defect to their side. The IHPL does *not* advise making deals with terrorists but does not expressly forbid it either.

Scoreboard Access

The scoreboard can be accessed at scoreboard.plinko.horse while on the competition network. This lets you check your team's score checks, modify scoring users, and submit injects.



On the "Overview" page, you will be able to see a table with all your services, their status over the last 10 minutes (passing or failing the check), and, at the bottom of the page, useful information about the checks that are currently failing. If a check is failing, you can click on the name of the service to view logs that will tell you at what part the check is failing (such as a wrong HTTP response code or a bad password for SSH check). These logs are very helpful during the competition.

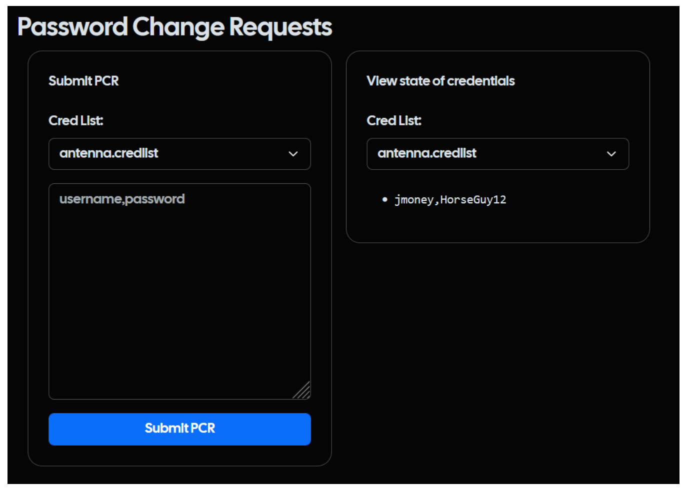
[5] We don't recommend it, but you *are* allowed to high-five or shake hands with the Red Team.

Modify Scoring User (Password Change Requests)

Certain score checks (covered below) require an automated login to the `jmoney` account on one of the boxes your team is responsible for. For this, they need an accurate password. If you change the password for the user involved in the score check, you will need to also change the password that the scoreboard uses to log in as that user.

To change the password used for a particular score check, log in to the scoreboard (scoreboard.plinko.horse) while on the competition network and click the PCRs tab. From here, you can either view your current credentials or use the "Submit PCR" box to change passwords on a given box. To do this:

1. Under Cred List, select the credential to change. It'll be in the format of `box_name.credlist`.
2. Enter a new username and password in the format `username,password` (no space before or after comma).
3. Click "Submit PCR."



Scored Services[6]

SSH (antenna 172.16.t.10, storkfront 172.16.t.20)

Both Linux boxes (172.16.t.10 and 172.16.t.20) need to allow the `jmoney` user to log in via SSH and run some basic *unprivileged* commands.

DNS (antenna 172.16.t.10)

The DNS server needs resolve name look-ups for your scored servers, for example:
`storkfront.teamt.plinko.horse -> 172.16.t.20`

RDP (depot 172.16.t.30, foreman 172.16.t.40)

Both windows boxes (172.16.t.30, 172.16.t.40) need to be able to be logged into via RDP with the `jmoney` user.

HTTP (storkfront 172.16.t.20)

The WooCommerce site needs to respond successfully to HTTP requests and return the correct information about our products. The box will be running Apache as a web server which in turn hosts the WordPress instance. The WooCommerce instance depends on being able to pull data from the MySQL server on `foreman`.

MySQL (foreman 172.16.t.40)

The `jmoney` user needs to be able to log in to MySQL on the `foreman` box and check that accurate data critical to the web-store is stored in the "`horsepress`" database (172.16.t.40).

FTP (depot 172.16.t.30)

The `anonymous` user needs to be able to log in and read the files currently stored in the `/memos` directory of the file share. The files need to be intact (verified by file name correlated to file hash). The box will be running `IIS FTP`.

[6] Scored services not final and subject to change without warning up to date of competition. No refunds will be issued due to changed score checks.

Interacting With Your Services

Here at the International Horse Plinko League, we want to make sure that you are well-prepared and can interface with the various services we use. This is a basic primer; we highly recommend you search through each technology and learn how to use them proficiently and protect them from the HLF.

SSH

SSH is a way to administer a machine remotely via command line. It is the management method of choice for Linux servers - it can be used with Windows as well, but this is much less common. When logging in with SSH, you have the choice of logging into the remote system with username and password, or username and private key.

You can use the SSH client on your laptop (Windows/MacOS/Linux will come with it) in the command line to log into your systems.

```
jmoney@plinktop:~$ ssh plinktern@172.16.t.5
The authenticity of host '172.16.t.5 (172.16.t.5)' can't be established.
ED25519 key fingerprint is SHA256:2PYldUsx10KY43ajcTXLfHuM6Ewb/6TmAiAfzBX7lCE.
This key is not known by any other names
Are you sure you want to continue connecting (yes/no/[fingerprint])? yes
Warning: Permanently added '172.16.t.5' (ED25519) to the list of known hosts.
plinktern@172.16.t.5's password:

Last login: Thu Oct 3 19:34:53 2024 from 198.18.1.230
plinktern@antenna:~ $
```

DNS (Domain Name System)

DNS maps IP addresses to domain names. All communication over the Internet is done via IP addresses, but these addresses are a pain to remember - imagine typing in `42.250.217.206` every time you want to visit Google. Domain names are human-readable names like `google.com` that are much easier to use.

You can use the command line tool **`nslookup`** (available on both Linux and Windows) to send queries over the network to a DNS server. We simply type the domain name we want to query (`depot.teamt.plinko.horse`)[7] and the DNS server we want to query (`172.16.t.10`), and we get the resolved IP address of `172.16.t.30`.

```
plinktern@antenna:~$ nslookup depot.teamt.plinko.horse 172.16.t.10
Server:         172.16.t.10
Address:        172.16.t.10#53

Name:    depot.teamt.plinko.horse
Address: 172.16.t.30
```

In order to see your DNS records on `antenna`, `cd` to the `/etc/bind` directory and run `cat db.teamt.plinko.horse`.

```
plinktern@antenna:/etc/bind$ cat db.teamt.plinko.horse
$TTL    86400
@ IN SOA ns.teamt.plinko.horse. admin.teamt.plinko.horse. (
        2023091801 ; Serial
        3600       ; Refresh
        1800       ; Retry
        604800     ; Expire
        86400 )    ; Minimum TTL

; Name servers
                               IN      NS      ns.teamt.plinko.horse.

; A record for the Name Server
ns.teamt.plinko.horse.         IN      A       172.16.t.10

; A Records
generator.teamt.plinko.horse.  IN      A       172.16.t.5
antenna.teamt.plinko.horse.    IN      A       172.16.t.10
storkfront.teamt.plinko.horse. IN      A       172.16.t.20
depot.teamt.plinko.horse.      IN      A       172.16.t.30
foreman.teamt.plinko.horse.    IN      A       172.16.t.40
```

[7] In the example inputs and outputs, `t` is used in place of the team number. You will not see this `t` when running commands in your environment.

To see your DNS zones, run `cat named.conf.default-zones` from inside the `/etc/bind` directory. The competition zone is `teamt.plinko.horse`.

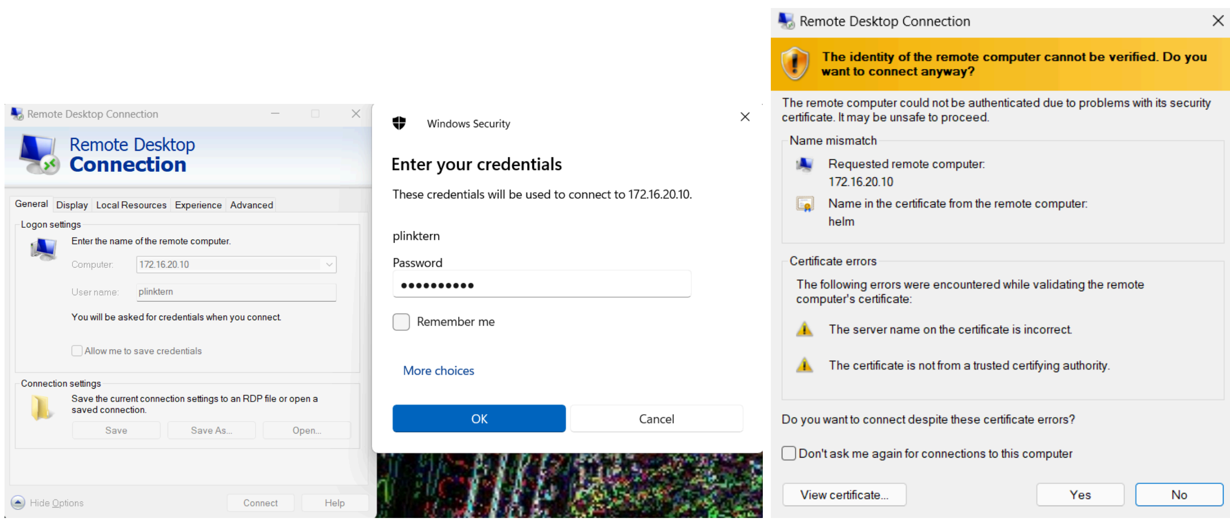
```
plinktern@antenna:/etc/bind$ cat named.conf.default-zones
// prime the server with knowledge of the root servers
zone "." {
        type hint;
        file "/usr/share/dns/root.hints";
};

// be authoritative for the localhost forward and reverse zones, and for
// broadcast zones as per RFC 1912

zone "localhost" {
        type master;
        file "/etc/bind/db.local";
};

zone "127.in-addr.arpa" {
        type master;
        file "/etc/bind/db.127";
};

zone "0.in-addr.arpa" {
        type master;
        file "/etc/bind/db.0";
};

zone "255.in-addr.arpa" {
        type master;
        file "/etc/bind/db.255";
};

zone "teamt.plinko.horse" {
        type master;
        file "/etc/bind/db.teamt.plinko.horse";
};
```

RDP

RDP is a way to administer a machine remotely with a GUI (graphical user interface). It is typically used only on Windows systems.

You will need an RDP client to connect to RDP. In Windows, you can use “Remote Desktop Connection”. If you are running MacOS or Linux on your laptop, you can use another RDP client like the Windows app (macOS) or Remmina (Linux).

When you connect, you will need to provide the IP address of the system you want to RDP into, along with the username and password. You will need to click “yes” to accept the machine’s certificate.



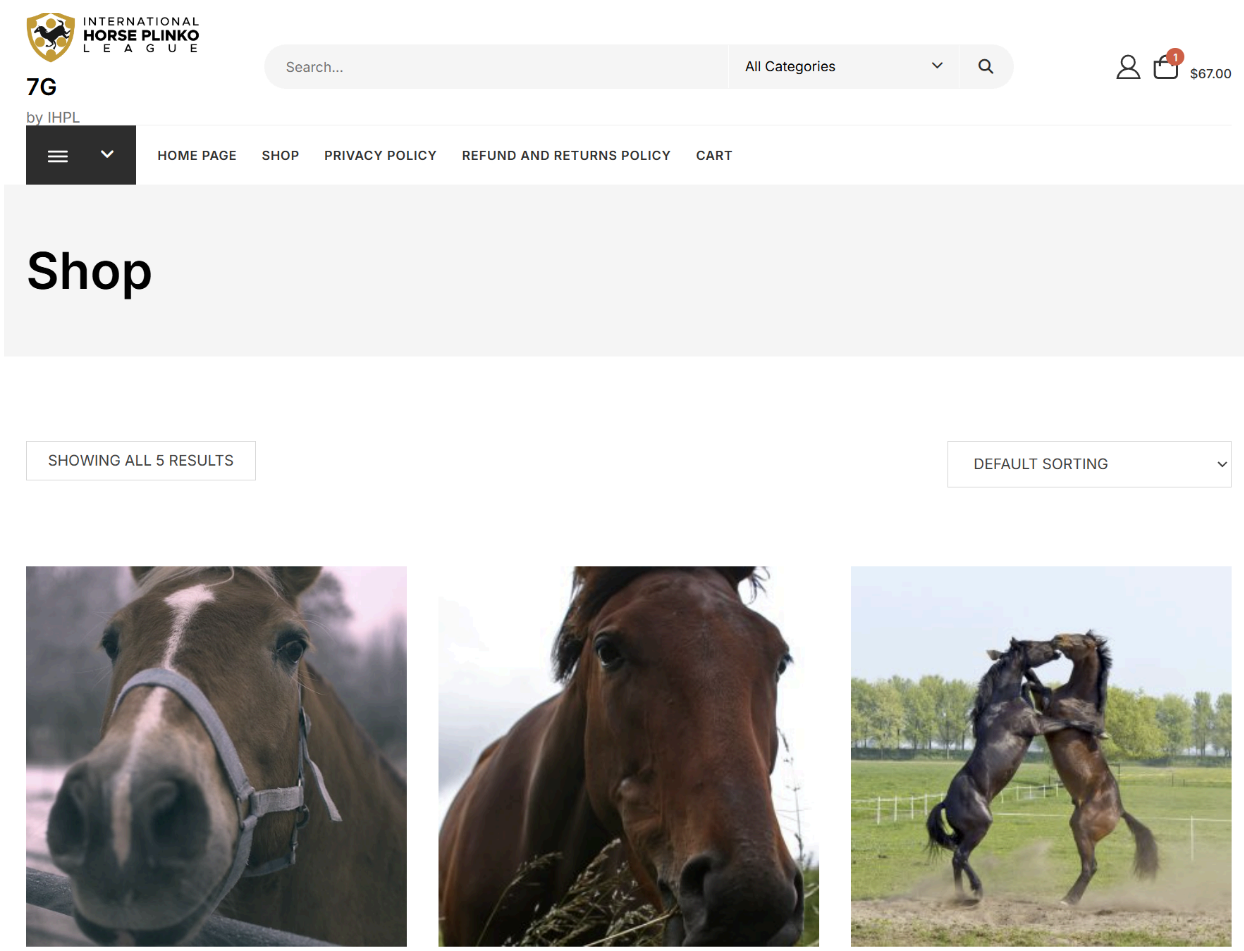
Now you are logged in, and can interact with the GUI just like a console!

HTTP (WooCommerce)

HTTP is the protocol that the web runs on. Your web browser (Firefox, Safari, Chrome, etc) sends HTTP requests to the web server (http://plinko.horse, etc), which sends HTTP responses back. The default port for HTTP is 80.

Your web server on Storkfront is running a web application called WooCommerce. This is a WordPress-based e-commerce website.

To access WooCommerce, visit `storkfront` in your web browser via IP address `http://172.16.t.20` or the DNS name `http://storkfront.teamt.plinko.horse`, `t` being your team number. This will pull up `the` website:



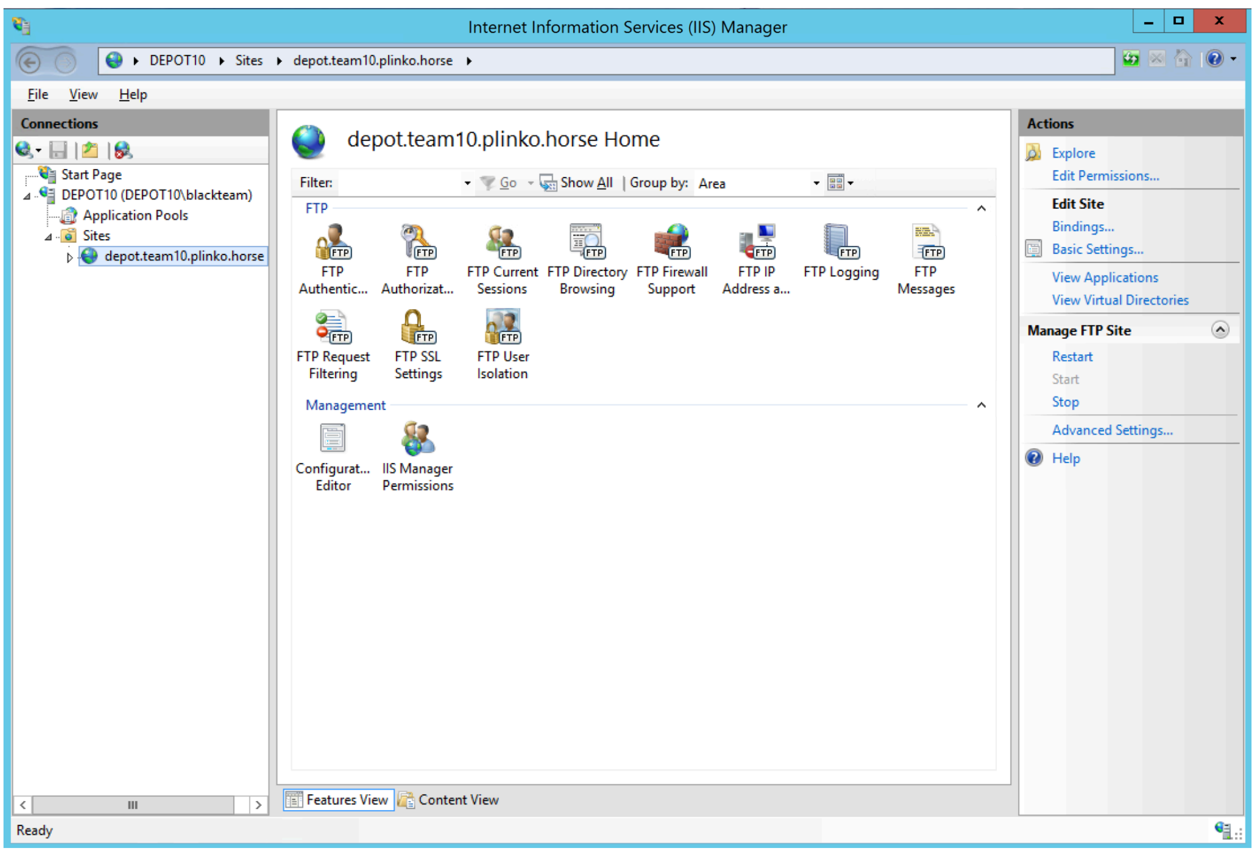
FTP

FTP is a file sharing protocol. You can think of it as a primitive OneDrive or Google Drive - files can be stored in a central location and accessed over the network.

Normally, you would log into an FTP server with a username and password. On your `depot` system, anonymous authentication is enabled. This allows anyone to access the FTP share without having to log in.

Anonymous FTP shares do not require a login to access. They use the special username `anonymous` and any password.[8]

Your FTP server is hosted on IIS, so in order to access it first open IIS, and then click on `depot.teamt.plinko.horse`. Click on "Explore" in the upper right hand corner to view the files. Team 10 is shown here as an example:



[8] Yes, *any* password.

You can also view the files via the command line. Type `ftp 172.16.t.30` into your terminal, enter `anonymous` as your user, and press enter when prompted for your password.

```
PS C:\Users\Administrator> ftp 172.16.t.30
Connected to 172.16.t.30.
220 Microsoft FTP Service
User (172.16.t.30:(none)): anonymous
331 Anonymous access allowed, send identity (e-mail name) as password.
Password:
230 User logged in.
ftp> ls
200 PORT command successful.
125 Data connection already open; Transfer starting.
passwords (DO NOT SHARE).txt
pranked!.txt
226 Transfer complete.
ftp: 47 bytes received in 0.02Seconds 2.94Kbytes/sec.
ftp>
```

MySQL

MySQL is a database. This is a structured way for data to be stored. Data is organized into tables with rows and columns, much like a spreadsheet. You can connect to a MySQL database and make SQL queries to create/destroy databases or tables, or add/remove data in a table.

A common use for MySQL databases is to store data for web applications. For example, your WooCommerce web application on `storkfront` uses the MySQL database on `foreman`. WooCommerce stores store data, users accounts, and more in the database.

You can log into the MySQL database yourself and look around! First log into your `depot` system via console or SSH. Then run the following command in the terminal.

```
mysql -u {username} -p
```

- `{username}` should be filled in with the username you have as a mysql user (see the Accessing Your Environment section for the default login).
- `-u` specifies the user
- `-p` specifies that you are using a password. Without the `-p` it will try to sign you in with no password

It will then prompt you to provide your password to login, and give you a MySQL shell. You can tell by the `mysql>` in the prompt.

```
Welcome to the MySQL monitor. Commands end with ; or \g.
Your MySQL connection id is 21
Server version: 9.4.0-log MySQL Community Server (GPL)

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affiliates. Other names may be trademarks of their respective
owners.

Type 'help;' or '\h' for help. Type '\c' to clear the current input statement.

mysql>
```

From here, you can use SQL commands to view or edit the MySQL databases and tables. Here is a good cheatsheet of different commands.

To leave the service type `exit` into the command prompt.

```
mysql> exit
Bye
```

Event Information

Team and Day Assignments

Everyone competing in the Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge has already created an account on CHRIS (hr.plinko.horse). This will be used to know your team and day assignments prior to competing, and to confirm your participation in HPCC.

When signing up for the Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge, you selected either Saturday or Sunday as your competition day. **Failure to show up on-time to your scheduled run may impact your ability to participate in the Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge in the future.** If you can no longer participate on your selected competition day, please leave your team so your spot can be filled.

Badge Pick-Up

All participants attending HPCC and related events between October 10th and 12th (including Friday's Opening Ceremony and all workshops) are required to pick up a ***7G***™ IHPL ID card, which will display your name, team, day of competition, and role. This will often be referred to as your *badge* or your ***7G***™ *card*. Participants are required to wear this badge at all times during the competition and related events. This includes those not participating in HPCC and only attending workshops and related events.

Badges can be picked up by anyone with a CHRIS account, including HPCC competitors and those only intending to participate in workshops.

A form of identification is required to pick up your IHPL ID card. Valid forms of identification include:

- A student ID (with your photo and full name printed on it) issued by a Florida university or state college.
- A REAL ID-compliant state identification card.
- A US passport card or Enhanced Drivers License.
- A passport book.[9]
- A NEXUS or Global Entry card.
- Any other form of photo identification deemed valid by the Real ID Act of 2005.
- Your profile from CHRIS loaded into a web browser.
- A credit or debit card that has not expired.
- A form signed by a notary public confirming your identity, with a photo attached.
- A Hack@UCF digital membership card.
- An IHPL ID card.[10]

[9] All valid ePassports (biometric passports) are accepted and will be verified. Only the photo page will be checked. That's all we care about.
[10] This includes IHPL ID cards from previous years.

- An HLF ID card.[11]
- A Costco membership card.
- A AAA membership card.
- A AAAA (Anti-AAA) membership card.
- An ORCA Regional Reduced Fare Permit (RRFP) card.

Using a physical ID card will allow us to expedite badge pick-up.

If you used a legal name when signing up for Horse Plinko and prefer to use a different name for *any reason*, please change it on CHRIS *immediately* (ideally before October 3rd).[12] We will use the name you put on CHRIS throughout the event.

Badges can be picked up during the times below:

Date	Location	Location Nickname
Thursday, October 9th 2:00 pm to 5:30 pm	ENG1-186	Lockheed Martin Cyber Innovation Lab
Friday, October 10th 10:00 am to 5:30 pm	ENG1-186	Lockheed Martin Cyber Innovation Lab
Friday, October 10th 5:30 pm to 6:00 pm	BA1-ATR	BA1 Atrium (outside of BA1-119)
Friday, October 10th 7:00 pm to 8:00 pm	ENG1-186	Lockheed Martin Cyber Innovation Lab
Saturday, October 11th 8:00 am to 10:00 am	ENG2-ATR	ENG2 Atrium
Saturday, October 11th 8:00 am to 10:00 am	ENG2-ATR	ENG2 Atrium

It is very important to **pick your badge up as early as possible!** Without your badge, you will not be able to compete in the Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge.

[11] HLF ID cards will be physically damaged upon issuing you an IHPL ID card. We also reserve the right to arrest you for terrorism in the case you identify yourself as a member of the Horse Liberation Front.
[12] Name change requests may be possible on-site after October 3rd, but will slow down check-in due to us needing to re-print your badge.

Location and Directions

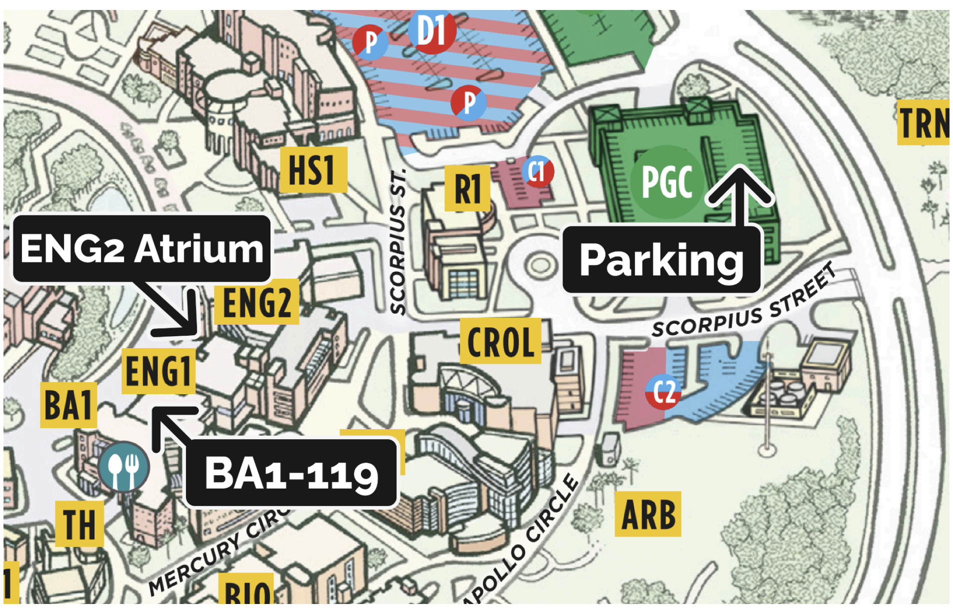
The Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge will be held at the University of Central Florida in the Engineering 1 and 2 buildings, with the Friday opening ceremony being held in the Business Administration 1 building. Please note that this is an exclusively in-person event.

Additionally, **you will need your IHPL ID card displayed prominently at all times!** If you do not have an IHPL ID card, you cannot participate in Horse Plinko or its workshops and may be denied entry to the event space. You will be provided with a lanyard and badge holder.

Getting to Campus

The Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge is located at the University of Central Florida's Engineering 1 and 2 buildings.

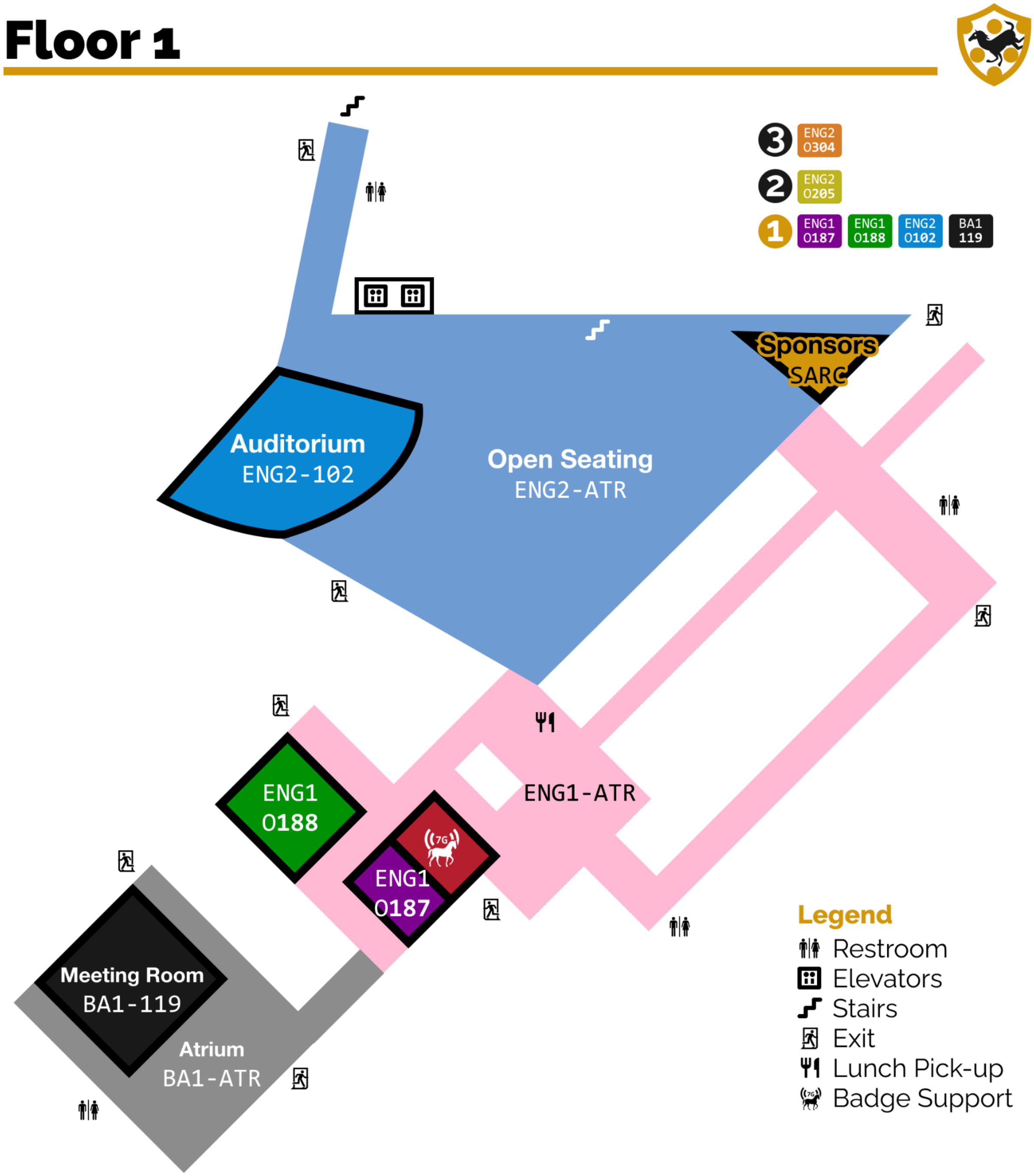
If you are driving to campus, you *must* park in [Parking Garage C], or you will be towed by UCF Parking Services. If you do not have a UCF parking permit, you can purchase a daily permit [on the UCF Parking services website here]. A 24-hour permit is $8 per day. To get to the event buildings from Parking Garage C, walk west along Scorpius Street, and make a left turn onto Mercury Circle until you reach the path between Engineering 1 and Business Administration 1. Then turn right, go straight until you reach the end of the path, and then turn right once again. You should be at the main entrance of Engineering 1. From here, you can easily walk to the Engineering 2 Atrium (primary event space) and the Business Administration buildings (Friday opening ceremony).



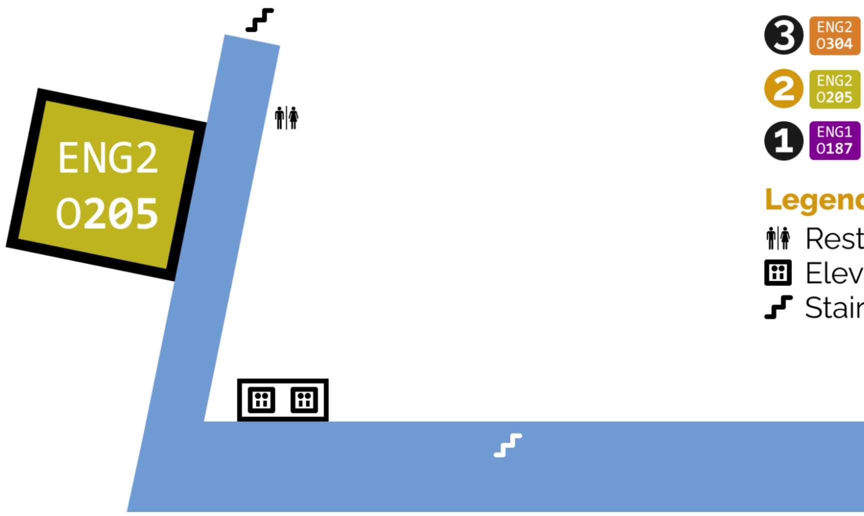
Public transportation is also available to the University of Central Florida via [Lynx], Orlando's public bus service. Check your favorite maps app, such as Apple Maps, Google Maps, or the [Transit] app, for more details on how to get it. The Lynx SuperStop is located on the opposite side of campus and is a 10-minute walk from Engineering 2.

Event Space

The following is a color-coded map of the Horse Plinko event space. Room numbers and associated colors will be used in the schedules.



Floor 2



3 ENG2 0304

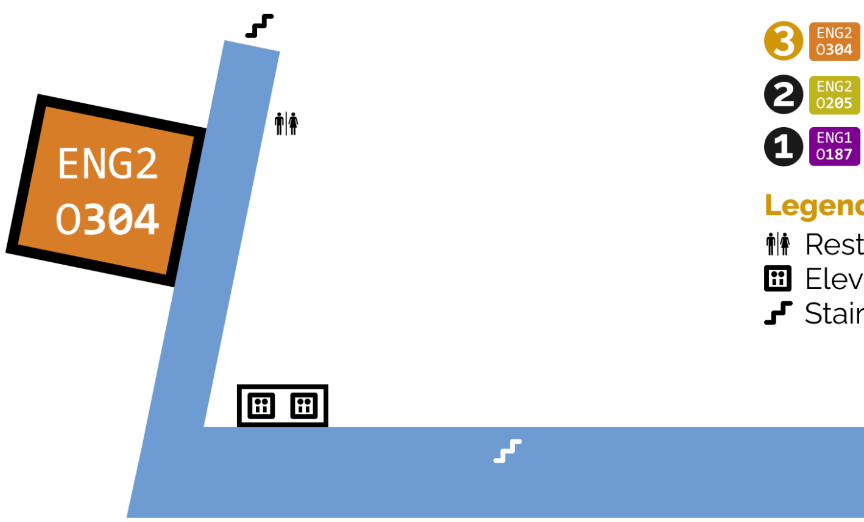
2 ENG2 0205

1 ENG1 0187 ENG1 0188 ENG2 0102 BA1 119

Legend

Restroom
Elevators
Stairs

Floor 3



3 ENG2 0304

2 ENG2 0205

1 ENG1 0187 ENG1 0188 ENG2 0102 BA1 119

Legend

Restroom
Elevators
Stairs

Schedule

Friday

The Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge opening ceremony events will occur on Friday, October 10th in BA1-119 starting at 5:30 pm. **All attendees must have an IHPL ID card!**

The Friday schedule can be found below:

Time	Location	Event
5:30 pm to 6:00 pm	BA1-ATR	**Sponsor Networking and Badge Pick-up:** Network with sponsors and get your badge (if you haven't already)!
6:00 pm to 7:00 pm	BA1-119	**Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge Opening Ceremony:** An introduction to Horse Plinko, including rules and other important information
7:00 pm to 8:00 pm	BA1-ATR	**Sponsor Networking:** Talk with our sponsors about their work!
7:00 pm to 7:45 pm	BA1-119	**Student Workshop:** TBA
7:45 pm to 8:30 pm	BA1-119	**Student Workshop:** TBA

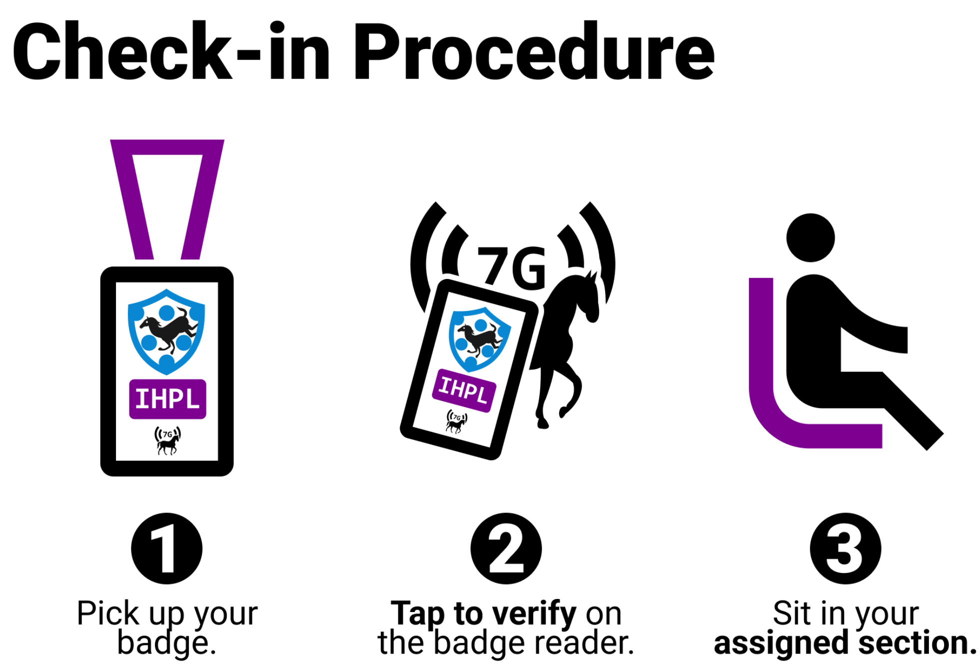
Day of Competition (Saturday *or* Sunday)

You have chosen to compete in the Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge on either Saturday or Sunday. This information is available on [CHRIS]() and on your IHPL ID card.

On your assigned day, you will report to ENG2-102 for *competition check-in*. This is a simple procedure to allow us to track who is present. **If you are not in ENG2-102 at 9:00 am or fail to perform competition check-in, you will be marked as a no-show, your spot will be freed, and your ability to compete in the future will be restricted.** HPCC is a limited-spot event, and this ensures we are able for as many people to participate as possible.

Competition check-in involves tapping your IHPL ID card at the badge readers outside of ENG2-102. After "badging in," you will be instructed to sit in a portion of the room assigned to you based on your competition room color. Your competition room's color is one of four colors: **purple**, **green**, **orange**, and **yellow**. If you have any questions, ask an IHPL staff member for assistance.

The check-in procedure is visualized below:



The schedule during the competition can be found below:

Time	Location	Event
9:00 am to 9:30 am	ENG2-102	**Day-of Briefing:** Introduction presentation
9:30 am to 10:00 am	Assigned Room	**Environment Setup:** Migration to competition rooms, network testing, and log-in.
10:00 am	Competition Begins!	
10:00 am to 12:00 pm	Assigned Room	**Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge:** The competition begins!
12:00 pm to 12:30 pm	ENG2-ATR	**Lunch** for **Purple** and **Green** rooms.
12:00 pm to 12:30 pm	SARC	**Sponsor Networking for Yellow and Orange rooms:** Talk with our industry partners about their work!
12:45 pm to 1:15 pm	ENG2-ATR	**Lunch** for **Yellow** and **Orange** rooms.
12:45 pm to 1:15 pm	SARC	**Sponsor Networking for Purple and Green rooms:** Talk with our industry partners about their work!
1:30 pm to 5:30 pm	Assigned Room	**Horse Plinko Cyber Challenge:** The competition continues!
5:30 pm	Hands Off Keyboard!	
5:45 pm to 6:30 pm	ENG2-102	**Sponsor and Alumni Q&A:** Talk with people from industry on their experiences in this open-forum Q&A panel.
6:30 pm to 7:00 pm	ENG2-102	**Closing Ceremony:** We recap your Plinkternship, winners are announced, and prizes are distributed.

Saturday

For those *not* competing on Saturday, here is the schedule of events:

Time	Location	Event
10:15 am to 11:00 am	ENG2-102	**Workshop:** Lockheed Martin Intro: Eric Trujillo
1:30 pm to 2:00 pm	ENG2-ATR	**Lunch** for non-competitors.
1:30 pm to 2:30 pm	SARC	**Sponsor Networking for non-competitors:** Talk with our industry partners about their work!
3:00 pm to 3:45 pm	ENG2-102	**Workshop:** Threatlocker, Simplifying Cybersecurity: Kieran Human
5:45 pm to 6:30 pm	ENG2-102	**Sponsor and Alumni Q&A:** Talk with people from industry on their experiences in this open-forum Q&A panel.

Sunday

For those *not* competing on Sunday, here is the schedule of events:

Time	Location	Event
10:15 am to 11:00 am	ENG2-102	**Workshop:** Lockheed Martin Intro: Eric Trujillo
1:30 pm to 2:00 pm	ENG2-ATR	**Lunch** for non-competitors.
1:30 pm to 2:30 pm	SARC	**Sponsor Networking for non-competitors:** Talk with our industry partners about their work!
5:45 pm to 6:30 pm	ENG2-102	**Sponsor and Alumni Q&A:** Talk with people from industry on their experiences in this open-forum Q&A panel.

Photo Release

When signing up for Horse Plinko, you can opt out of the photo release. Through opting out, you will not be included in photos taken by our onsite photographers. Day-of, you will receive a **no-photo red lanyard** dictating a refusal of photography.

Prizes

Thanks to our amazing sponsors, we were able to obtain prizes for first, second, and third place for each placing team member, for each run of HPCC! These will be revealed and awarded at the Closing Ceremony at the end of each day's competition.

Thanks to our generous sponsors!

We appreciate the dedication of our sponsors to fostering the next generation of IHPL's (unpaid) cyber talent!

If you are interested in working outside of the IHPL in the cyber field, we would recommend checking out the organizations below!

They will be tabling throughout Horse Plinko weekend in the SARC room at designated times. Ask a White Team member for directions if needed.

Platinum

LOCKHEED MARTIN

https://www.lockheedmartinjobs.com

REDSEER

https://www.linkedin.com/company/red-seer-inc/jobs/

INTERNATIONAL HORSE PLINKO LEAGUE

Gold

THREATLOCKER

https://www.threatlocker.com/company/careers

amazon

https://amazon.jobs/content/en/career-programs/university

https://hackerone.com/amazonvrp

Silver

DARK WOLF SOLUTIONS

https://rkwolfsolutions.com/join-the-pack

TEXAS INSTRUMENTS

https://careers.ti.com/en/sites/CX

CTFd

https://ctfd.io

NAVAL NUCLEAR LABORATORY

https://navalnuclearlab.energy.gov/careers/

RESEARCH INNOVATIONS

https://www.researchinnovations.com/careers

INTERNATIONAL HORSE PLINKO LEAGUE

Bronze

GUIDEPOINT SECURITY

https://www.guidepointsecurity.com/careers/

Alumni

TriCat
A collective by Ravy and Shuga
https://tricat.dev

goober McKeever/guytux

kcolley

infosecanon